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Robot Vacuums 2026 Buying Guide: Roomba vs Shark, Docked vs No Dock

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Ever feel like a robot vacuum is a luxury you can’t afford? In 2026 manufacturers are promising that the new models will clean faster, mop better, and even empty themselves. Yet the sheer number of options can leave you stuck in a price-vs-performance loop.

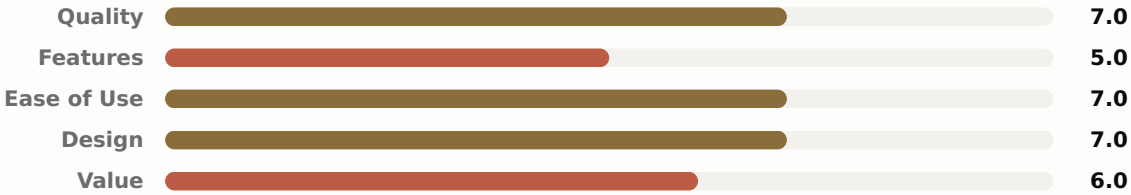
This guide will cut through the noise so you can decide quickly: buy a Roomba or a Shark, pick a dock for a hands-free experience, or stay simple. Get ready to stop second-guessing and start choosing.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

What you’re looking for

All families have one question: how often will I need to open the vacuum, empty its bag, and wipe the floor down? A high-rating model that skips that step will save you time (and a little less dust). The rest of this guide shows you the leading options for the 2026 lineup.

Roomba 115X – Stripe-priced, auto-empty benefits



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

- **Combo Vacuum & Mop (no dock)** – $139.99, 4.4★ (5,217 reviews). 3K+ units sold month-ago.
- **Combo + Auto-Empty Dock** – $199.99, 4.4★ (5,217 reviews). 6K+ units sold month-ago.

The dock raises the price by $60 but removes the manual emptying step. For a family that values convenience over a little extra spend, the docked version is the clear winner.

Shark AI Ultra – higher price, lower rating

- **Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum** – $249.99, 4.0★ (23,990 reviews).
- **Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum** – $239.99, 4.0★ (23,990 reviews).

Shark offers excellent suction but falls behind on overall rating and shows no distinct docked version in this price range. If you prioritize brand over convenience, Shark’s manual models still deliver strong performance.

Patch Wild Numbers – see the proof

Looking at recent sales, the Roomba 115X with dock sells twice as many units as its non-docked brother—proof that many shoppers prefer the hands-free option. Meanwhile, Shark’s higher price and similar rating suggest a mismatch between cost and perceived benefit.

Make Your Decision

Weight your priorities:

- Need *automatic* emptying? Go Roomba 115X with dock.
- Comfort with a manual bag? Cheap Roomba or Shark works.

- Prefer Shark’s suction? Pick the Square-Free model but be ready for manual emptying.

Once you’re ready, visit Amazon and grab the variant that matches your budget and lifestyle. Happy cleaning!